

Rewind – "The Cutting Room Floor" Design Doc

Core Aesthetic

Color-blocked neobrutalism. The app is built from bold, thick-bordered rectangles of deep color – ink navy, charcoal, slate blue, muted clay, warm cream – arranged like a screen-printed poster. Each section owns its background color; thick black borders and heavyweight type unify everything into one cohesive piece. The colors are rich but restrained – loud enough to be interesting, quiet enough that cover art is always the star.

This isn't dark mode. It isn't light mode. It's **block mode**.

App Structure

Same bones as every direction. Two states, three tabs, same rules.

LOGGED OUT:

```
+-----+
|  Landing page (split layout + auth modals)  |
+-----+
```

LOGGED IN:

```
+-----+
|  Navbar:  [ Home ]  [ Discover ]  [ Watchlist ]  |
|                                                  |
|  Home      = Your backlog (randomized display)  |
|  Discover  = TMDB search + trending defaults    |
|  Watchlist = Completed items from your backlog  |
+-----+
```

Universal Interaction Rules

Every poster card across the app behaves consistently:

Interaction	Behavior
Click poster	Opens Media Detail page (always, on every page)
Poster hover	Metadata slides up from bottom + action buttons reveal

Item states and what you can do with them:

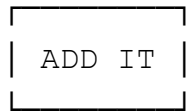
State	Where it appears	Available actions
Not saved	Discover results	Add to Backlog
In backlog	Home grid, Discover (with block badge)	Remove, Mark Completed
Completed	Watchlist, Discover (with muted badge)	Move back to Backlog, Remove entirely

Two Interaction Languages

The UI speaks in two gears:

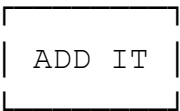
Mechanical press – for actions (buttons, toggles, filters). Elements have hard offset shadows. On click, the shadow collapses and the element shifts down, like pressing a physical button into a surface. On release, it springs back.

Default:



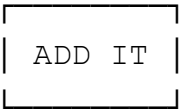
4px offset

Hover:



6px offset

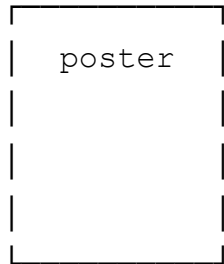
Click:



0px – pressed flat

Reveal + transform – for content discovery (posters, cards). Hover a poster and a dark overlay slides up from the bottom with title, metadata, and action buttons. Content transforms to invite exploration – things move, slide, and snap with purpose.

Default:



Hover:



overlay slides up

Navbar (Logged In)

```
inactive = ink navy fill, white text
```

- | | | |
|----------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| REWIND | poster 1
(-2°) | post 2
(+3°) |
| press play
on the past. | poster 3
(+4°) | poster 4
(-1°) |
| LOG IN | post 5
(+2°) | poster 6
(-3°) |
| | | |
| SIGN UP | | |
| | | |

ink navy background	slate blue background
---------------------	-----------------------

Left Side – Brand + Auth

- Background: ink navy (#0A1628)
- "REWIND" – Satoshi Black, 3rem , white, letter-spacing: 0.25em
- "press play on the past." – Satoshi Regular, 1rem , rgba (255,255,255,0.6) , lowercase
- Log In button – cream fill, black text, 3px black border, hard shadow. Mechanical press on click
- Sign Up button – outlined (3px white border), white text, transparent fill. Same press behavior
- Generous whitespace – the left side breathes. It's a poster, not a form

Right Side – Poster Cascade

Background: slate blue (#334155), creating a clear color block split.

- 8-10 trending posters arranged asymmetrically at varied sizes and slight rotations (-4deg to +4deg)
- Each poster has a thick white border (3px) and a hard black offset shadow (4px 4px 0)
- Sizes vary – some small, some large, creating visual rhythm
- Subtle drift animation: each poster floats 3-5px vertically on a slow loop (10-15s), staggered start times so they move independently
- Posters overlap slightly – the cascade feels like someone arranged covers on a corkboard
- On hover: individual poster lifts (shadow grows to 8px), slight brightness increase

Data: GET /tmdb/trending – fetch ~10 posters, assign each a size, rotation, and position.

Auth Modals

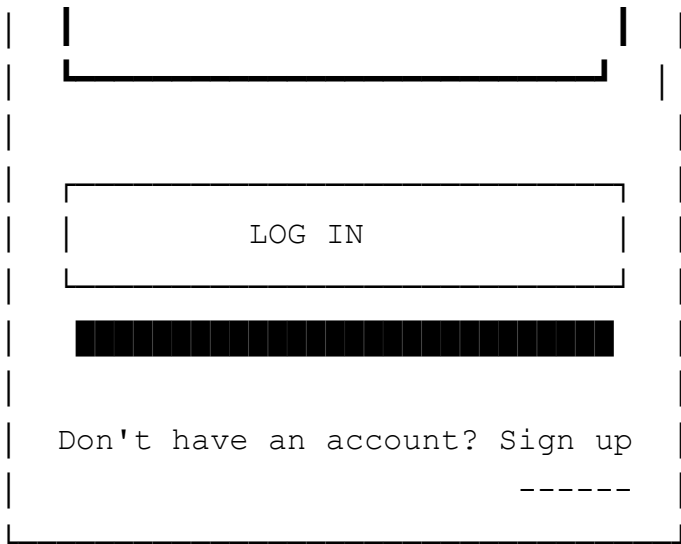
Clicking Log In or Sign Up opens a modal over the landing page.

LOG IN

[X]

USERNAME

PASSWORD



```
cream card (#FFFDF5)
3px black border, hard shadow
inputs: 3px black border, no radius
button: mechanical press
```

- Cream card (#FFFDF5) with 3px black border and hard offset shadow
- Inputs: thick-bordered, sharp corners(0 border-radius), Satoshi Regular
- Labels: Satoshi Bold, uppercase, small, tracked out – above each input
- Submit button: ink navy fill, cream text, mechanical press interaction
- Bottom link toggles between Log In <-> Sign Up
- Backdrop dims the landing page; poster cascade keeps drifting behind

Home (Your Backlog)

The main logged-in screen. Color-blocked into two zones: the Dig It Up hero at top, and the backlog grid below.

Layout



DONE

REMOVE

MY BACKLOG

14 saved

JetBrains

Mono

Sort: ▾

Genre: ▾

poster

poster

poster

poster

poster

Title

Title

Title

Title

Title

Saved Mar

Saved Feb

Saved Jan

Saved Dec

Saved Nov

charcoal background (#1C1C1C)

poster cards have 3px black border + hard shadow

Empty: "NOTHING HERE YET." in huge Satoshi Black

"Head to Discover and start collecting."

Dig It Up (Hero Block)

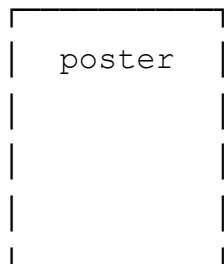
- Full-width color block: muted clay (#8B5E3C) background, 3px black border top and bottom
- Shows the **oldest item** in your backlog (earliest `date_added`)
- Poster on the left with thick white border, hard shadow
- **"DIG IT UP"** – Satoshi Black, huge (`2.5rem`), white text. The section name IS a call to action
- Title, metadata in white. "Saved 8 months ago" in JetBrains Mono
- Two buttons: **DONE** (cream fill, black text, press interaction) and **REMOVE** (outlined, white text)
- Feels like a bold label stuck on top of your pile – "hey, remember this one?"

Backlog Grid

- Background: charcoal (#1C1C1C)
- **"MY BACKLOG"** in Satoshi Black, white, large. Count ("14 saved") in JetBrains Mono, right-aligned
- **Sort/Genre dropdowns:** thick-bordered blocks (not subtle selects). 3px black border, cream fill, mechanical press to open. Dropdown menus also thick-bordered
- **Poster grid:** 5 cols desktop / 2 mobile. Each card has 3px black border + 4px hard offset shadow
- **Default order: randomized** on every page load (client-side shuffle)
- **Sort options:** "Random" (default), "Earliest Saved", "Latest Saved"
- **Genre filter:** populated from genres in user's backlog
- Card caption below poster: title in Satoshi Bold, "Saved [date]" in JetBrains Mono

Poster Hover (Home Grid)

Default:



4px shadow

Hover:



6px shadow, card lifts

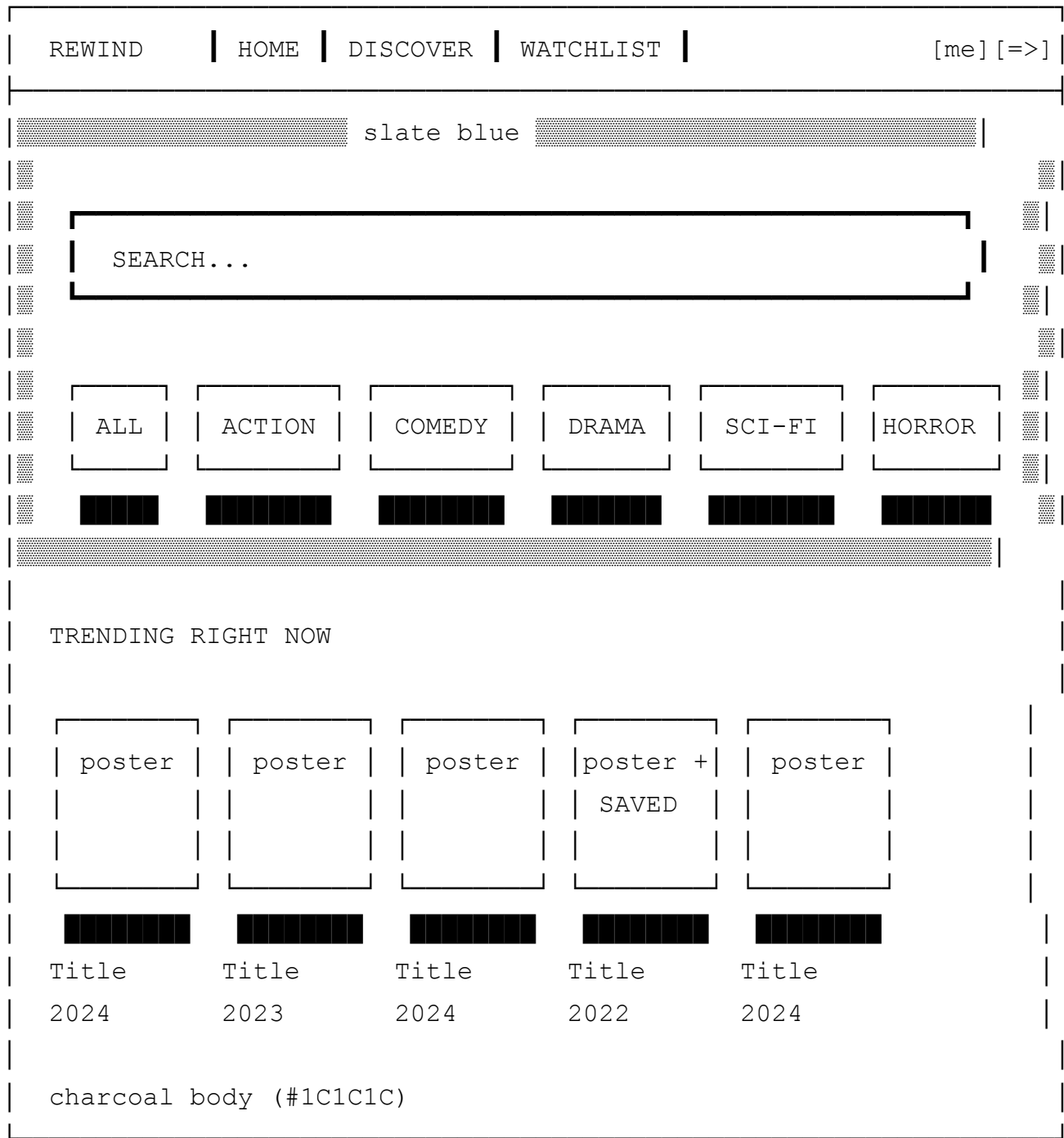
- Dark overlay slides up from the bottom on hover
- Title in Satoshi Bold, white
- [✓] = marks completed → moves to Watchlist (cream block button, press interaction)
- [x] = removes from backlog (outlined, muted)
- Card lifts 2px and shadow grows on hover (content feels like it's rising toward you)

Backlog Features Summary

Feature	How it works
Add movie/show	From Discover page → block badge toggle
Remove movie/show	Hover [x] on Home grid, or Discover toggle, or detail view
Genre filter	Dropdown filters the grid by genre
Randomized display	Client-side shuffle on load, "Random" sort option
Sort earliest/latest	Sort dropdown changes grid order by <code>date_added</code>
Mark completed	Hover [✓] on Home grid, or Dig It Up hero button → moves to Watchlist

Discover (Search + Trending)

Two color zones: the search bar area lives in a slate blue header block, results fill the charcoal body below.



Search Header Block

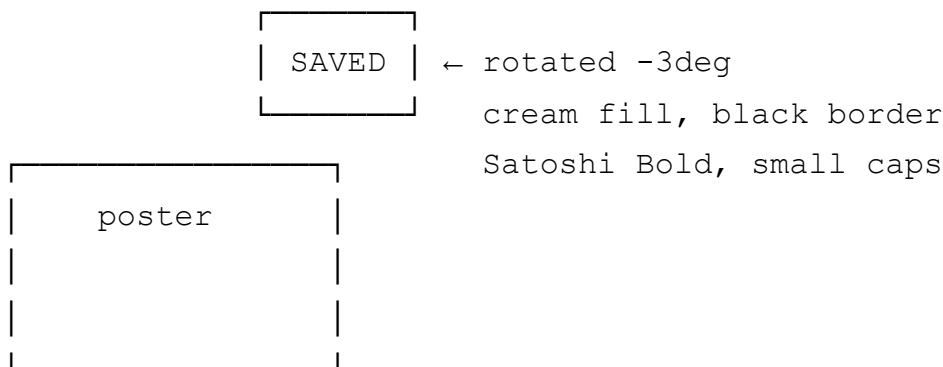
- Background: slate blue (#334155), 3px black border bottom
- Search input: full-width, cream fill (#FFDF5), 3px black border, Satoshi Regular, oversized placeholder("SEARCH...") in JetBrains Mono
- **Genre filters:** thick-bordered block buttons in a row. Each is its own mini color block:
 - Inactive: cream fill, black text, 3px black border, hard shadow

- Active: ink navy fill, cream text — **mechanical press** (shadow collapses, block snaps into its pressed state and STAYS pressed until toggled off)
- Filters feel like physical switches you slam down

Results Grid

- Background: charcoal (#1C1C1C)
- **"TRENDING RIGHT NOW"** — Satoshi Black, white, large (shown when search bar is empty)
- When searching: header changes to **"RESULTS"** with the query in JetBrains Mono next to it
- Same poster grid as Home: 5 cols desktop / 2 mobile, thick borders, hard shadows
- **Status badges on posters:**
 - Not saved → no badge, hover reveals [+ ADD] overlay
 - In backlog → bold **"SAVED"** stamp in top-right corner (cream block, 2px black border, slight rotation -3deg)
 - Completed → muted poster + **"DONE"** stamp overlay
- Save toggle: clicking the stamp or hover button adds/removes without navigating away
- Clicking a card (not the badge) opens **Media Detail Page**

The SAVED Stamp

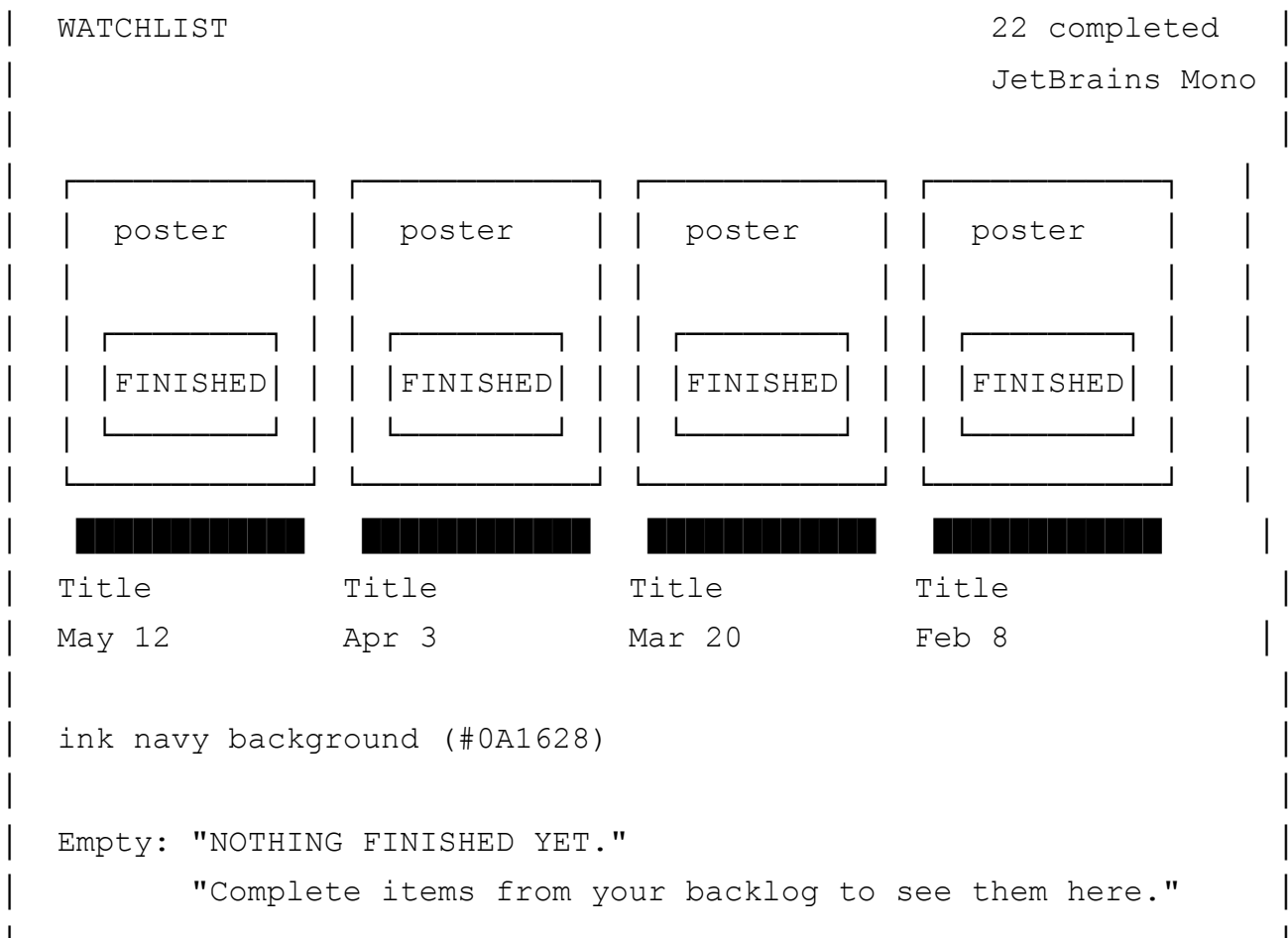


A small rectangular stamp in the top-right corner of saved posters. Thick border, slight rotation, bold type. Unmistakable at a glance — you know what's in your backlog without hovering.

Watchlist (Completed Items)

The trophy wall. Same grid structure, but with a distinct color block identity.

REWIND	HOME	DISCOVER	WATCHLIST	[me] [=>]
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- **Background: ink navy** (#0A1628) – different from Home's charcoal, giving each tab its own identity
- **"WATCHLIST"** in Satoshi Black, white. Count in JetBrains Mono, right-aligned
- Poster grid with thick borders, hard shadows (same treatment as everywhere)
- Each card has a **"FINISHED"** stamp centered on the poster – muted clay fill (#8B5E3C), 3px black border, slight rotation (-5deg), Satoshi Bold. Feels like a bold rubber stamp
- Completion date below title in JetBrains Mono
- Sorted by completion date (newest first)
- **Hover actions:** [UNDO] and [REMOVE] – same overlay-slide-up pattern, same mechanical press buttons
- No genre filters – simple collection
- The ink navy background makes this feel like a distinct room in the app, not just "home but different"

Media Detail Page

No full-bleed backdrop. Instead: a bold, structured card that presents the media item like a poster on a gallery wall.

poster
(large,
thick
border)

TITLE OF THE MOVIE

2024 · Action, Sci-Fi · 2h 14m

Description text goes here. It
sits cleanly on the cream card,
readable and direct. No drama,
just the information you need...

States:

- Not saved:

+ ADD TO BACKLOG

- In backlog:

DONE

REMOVE

- Completed:

UNDO FINISH

REMOVE

cream card (#FFFDF5) with 3px black border
on charcoal background

- Background: charcoal(#1C1C1C)
- **Detail card:** cream(#FFFDF5) with thick black border(3px) and large hard shadow(6px 6px 0 black)

- Large poster on the left with thick black border + hard shadow
- **Title:** Satoshi Black, ink navy text, huge (`2rem`)
- **Metadata line:** JetBrains Mono, slate (`#334155`), dot-separated (year · genre · runtime)
- **Description:** Satoshi Regular, charcoal text, comfortable line-height
- **Action buttons:** all mechanical press — primary actions get ink navy fill + cream text, destructive gets outlined
- Button state changes based on whether item is in backlog, completed, or neither
- The card IS the page — centered, generous padding, everything contained in one bold rectangle

Typography & Color

Token	Value
Display font	Satoshi — geometric sans, variable weight. Black (900) for headlines, Bold (700) for emphasis, Regular (400) for body
Mono font	JetBrains Mono — metadata, counts, dates, code-like labels
Hero/page titles	2.5rem, Satoshi Black
Section headers	1.5rem, Satoshi Bold
Body text	0.875–1rem, Satoshi Regular
Metadata	0.75–0.875rem, JetBrains Mono

The Block Palette

COLOR BLOCKS (section backgrounds):

- #0A1628

Ink Navy

—

landing left, watchlist, primary buttons
- #1C1C1C

Charcoal

—

home body, discover body, detail page bg
- #334155

Slate Blue

—

landing right, discover header, metadata text
- #8B5E3C

Muted Clay

—

dig-it-up hero, stamps, warm accents
- #FFFDF5

Warm Cream

—

cards, modals, active tab, input fills

STRUCTURAL:

- #000000

Black

————

borders (3px), shadows (4-6px offset),
dividers
- #FFFFFF

White

————

text on dark blocks, poster borders on dark
bg

TEXT:

- On dark backgrounds → #FFFFFF (white) or #FFFDF5 (cream)
- On light backgrounds → #0A1628 (ink navy) or #1C1C1C (charcoal)
- Muted metadata ——— #94A3B8 (cool gray)

How Color Blocking Works

Each major section of the app gets its own background color from the block palette. Cohesion comes from:

- 1. **Consistent border treatment** — every element has 3px black borders and hard offset shadows
- 2. **Consistent typography** — Satoshi + JetBrains Mono everywhere, same size scale
- 3. **Consistent interaction** — mechanical press on all buttons, reveal-slide on all posters

The colors VARY but the bones are IDENTICAL. That's what makes it feel cohesive instead of chaotic.

The app as a poster:

CHARCOAL — navbar		
INK NAVY	SLATE BLUE	← landing
brand + auth	poster cascade	
MUTED CLAY — hero section		← home
CHARCOAL — content grid		
SLATE BLUE — search header		← discover
CHARCOAL — results grid		
INK NAVY — watchlist		← watchlist

Implementation Notes

CSS-first approach: Neobrutalism is one of the easiest styles to implement.

- **Borders:** border: 3px solid black on everything

- **Shadows:** `box-shadow: 4px 4px 0 black` (no blur, pure offset)
- **Press interaction:** on `:active`, set `box-shadow: none` + `transform: translate(4px, 4px)` — element sinks to where the shadow was
- **Hover lift:** `box-shadow: 6px 6px 0 black` + `transform: translate(-2px, -2px)`
- **Color blocks:** each section wrapper gets its bg color via CSS custom properties
- **No border-radius anywhere** — sharp corners are the whole point
- **No gradients** — flat color fills only
- **Reveal overlay:** poster `:hover ::after` with `transform: translateY(100% → 0)`, dark background, `transition: 200ms ease-out`
- **Type scale:** CSS custom properties for the Satoshi weight/size system + JetBrains Mono

Google Fonts: Satoshi isn't on Google Fonts (it's from Fontshare, free for commercial use). JetBrains Mono is on Google Fonts.

Optional stretch libraries:

- **Framer Motion** — page transitions, poster entrance stagger, spring physics for press animations
- **CSS-only fallback** — everything above works with pure CSS transitions. Framer adds polish but isn't required

What makes this easy: No rounded corners to calculate. No gradient overlays. No backdrop blurs. No complex shadows. The visual impact comes entirely from **thick borders + bold type + color contrast** — three CSS properties doing all the work.